Why instructors do or do not use retrieval practice: an interview study

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Abstract

We interviewed 26 instructors about adopting low-stakes quizzing. Three themes described what helped and what stood in the way: workload, student pushback, and how much quizzes should count.

1. Methods

Design: qualitative interview study. Participants: 26 instructors from nine teaching-focused institutions, sampled purposively for variation in discipline and experience. Data: semi-structured interviews of 40-60 minutes, analysed with reflexive thematic analysis.

2. Results

Three themes were developed: the marking workload of frequent quizzes, students pushing back against frequent assessment, and uncertainty about how much quizzes should count towards the grade.

3. Limitations

The sample came only from teaching-focused institutions, so transferability to research-intensive universities is limited.

Fictional paper generated to test evidence-table extraction. Authors, journal, data and results are invented.